Answers and talk notes

Solve Problems with Unit Rates

What your student is learning

Tonight we write comparisons with cost on top and quantity on bottom, divide both parts by the bottom number to find the unit rate in fraction form over 1, and choose the better seller.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **C.** $6.50. $13 ÷ 2 = $6.50 for 1 sub.
2. **A.** $15. 12 × $1.25 = $15 for 12 bottles.
3. **B.** Seller 2, $3 per hat. Seller 2 is $18 ÷ 6 = $3 per hat, so Seller 2, $3 per hat, is the better deal than $3.50.
4. **C.** $7.00. 20 × $0.35 = $7.00 for 20 pencils.
5. **D.** $2.50. $20 ÷ 8 = $2.50 for 1 melon.

Talk about it

Which seller has the lower unit rate, and how did you use it to price the whole order?

Home mission

Find two shelf tags for the same item in different sizes. Write each as cost over amount, like $13.80 over 6. Divide the top and the bottom by the bottom number. Which is cheaper for 1?

When they are stuck, ask

- Cost on TOP, amount on the BOTTOM. Now divide both parts by the bottom number.
- The unit rate is a fraction over 1 (like 2.50/1). What does each number tell us?
- Why can the bigger total still be the cheaper deal per item?

Try not to say

- Pick the one with the smaller total price.
- Divide the number of items by the price.
- Divide only the top number without dividing the bottom.